Thumb rules: Vedic astronomy and Jyotish

વૈદિક ખગોળ અને જ્યોતિષના અંગૂઠા-નિયમો · from hardyshah.github.io/Swaminarayan/solar-system.html

The sky's ruler · આકાશનું માપ

1. **360°** = 12 rashis × 30° = 27 nakshatras × 13°20′ = 108 charans × 3°20′.
2. **1 rashi** = 2¼ nakshatras = 9 charans.
3. The **sun** moves about 1° a day. The **moon** moves about 13° a day, so it gains 12° a day on the sun.
4. **Dhruva's height** above the horizon = your latitude.
5. Stars rise **4 minutes earlier** each day, 2 hours a month.

The five limbs · પંચાંગ

6. **Tithi** = (Moon − Sun) ÷ 12°, rounded up. 1–15 sud, 16–30 vad. Punam at 180°, amas at 0°.
7. The **tithi at sunrise** is the day's tithi. Not at any sunrise: kshaya. At two sunrises: vriddhi.
8. A tithi lasts **19 to 26 hours**; 23 h 37 m on average.
9. **Nakshatra** = Moon ÷ 13°20′, rounded up. It changes about once a day; a charan about every 6 hours.
10. **Yoga** = (Sun + Moon) ÷ 13°20′. **Karana** = half a tithi = 6°.
11. **Vaar** runs sunrise to sunrise. Order slow to fast: Shani, Guru, Mangal, Surya, Shukra, Budh, Chandra; step three forward for the next day.

Months and years · માસ અને વર્ષ

12. A month is named after the **nakshatra at its full moon**: Chitra → Chaitra, Krittika → Kartik.
13. **Amanta** (Gujarat) ends at amas; **purnimanta** (north) ends at punam, so its vad half is one month ahead.
14. Lunar year 354 days, solar 365: **11 days short**. Adhik maas about every 32½ months, 7 in 19 years.
15. A lunar month with **no sankranti** is adhik.
16. **Sankranti** falls about the 14th–17th of each English month; Makar Sankranti on 14 January.
17. **Vikram Samvat** = CE + 57 after Diwali (Gujarat), + 56 before. **Shaka** = CE − 78 after Chaitra, − 79 before.
18. True uttarayan is 21–22 December; Makar Sankranti is 24 days later. The gap is the ayanamsha.

Precession · અયનચલન

19. **Ayanamsha** is about 24° now and grows 1° in 72 years (50″ a year).
20. **Nirayana = Sayana − ayanamsha.** A Western sun sign is usually one rashi ahead of the Indian one.

21. The pole goes round once in about **25,800 years**: Thuban 2800 BCE, Polaris now, near Vega about 14,000 CE.

The grahas · ગ્રહ

22. Time in one rashi: Moon 2¼ days; Sun, Budh, Shukra about 1 month; Mangal 1½ months; Guru 1 year; Rahu–Ketu 1½ years; Shani 2½ years.
23. One full round: Guru 12 years, Rahu–Ketu 18.6 years, Shani 29½ years.
24. Budh is never more than **28°** from the sun, Shukra never more than **47°**: look for them only near sunrise or sunset.
25. Mangal, Guru and Shani go **vakri** when opposite the sun, and are brightest then.
26. **Rahu and Ketu** are always 180° apart and move backward.

Eclipses · ગ્રહણ

27. Solar eclipse only at **amas**, lunar only at **punam**, and only when that day falls near Rahu or Ketu.
28. Eclipse seasons come about every **173 days**. The pattern repeats after 18 years 11 days (saros).

Time of day · દિવસનો સમય

29. 1 day = 60 ghadi. 1 ghadi = 24 minutes. 1 muhurta = 2 ghadi = 48 minutes.
30. **Lagna** changes about every 2 hours. At sunrise it is the sun's rashi; at sunset the 7th from it.
31. **Choghadiya** = daytime ÷ 8 (and night ÷ 8). Rahu kaal is one of the eight day parts.

Jyotish · જ્યોતિષ

32. Three branches: **Siddhanta** (computing), **Samhita** (the world), **Hora** (the person).
33. **Janma rashi** = the moon's rashi at birth. **Janma nakshatra** = the moon's nakshatra at birth.
34. **Vimshottari** = 120 years: Ketu 7, Shukra 20, Surya 6, Chandra 10, Mangal 7, Rahu 18, Guru 16, Shani 19, Budh 17. Nakshatras take these lords in order from Ashwini.
35. **Ganita** can be checked against the sky. **Phalita** (prediction) is tradition; tests have not found it better than chance.

Big numbers · મોટી સંખ્યાઓ

36. Kali yuga 4,32,000 years. Mahayuga 43,20,000 = 10 × Kali, in parts 4:3:2:1. Kalpa = 1,000 mahayugas = 4.32 billion years.
37. The sun moves about **200 km/s** round the Milky Way, 26,000 light-years from its centre, one lap in about 230 million years.

Numbers are rounded for memory. Astronomy rules (ganita) can be checked against the sky; rules of phalita jyotish are given as the tradition states them, not as tested science. Sources and links are listed on the page.